

Career Essentials:

Preparing for an Interview



Career Services

What emoji represents how you feel about interviewing?

- Use the chat emojis
- Click on the smiley face

Learning Objectives

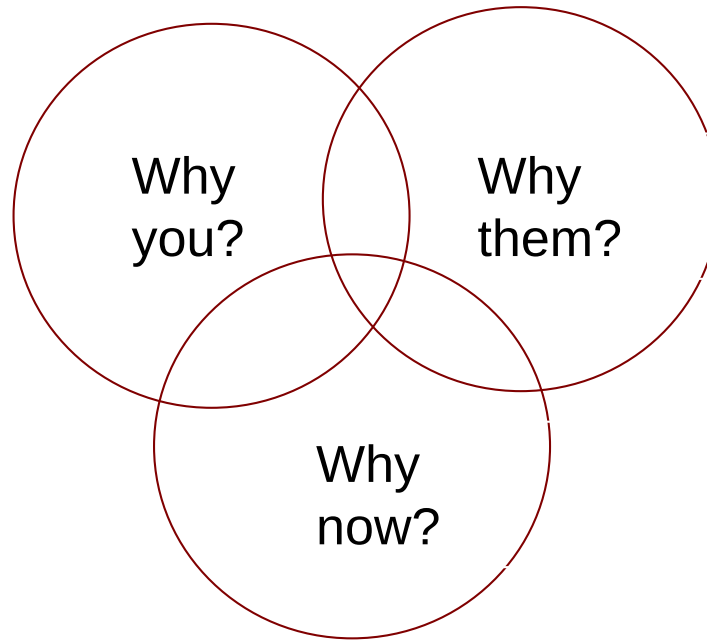
- Better understand the key steps to preparing for competitive MBA Level interviews
- Inform and enhance your interview preparation through a wide range of Booth resources

Agenda

- Interviewing Overview
- 3 Steps to Prepare
- Quiz
- Next Steps & Resources

Interviewing : Show your fit throughout

- Your experiences, accomplishments, skills and how you can help the organization.



- Research the organization and position - organization website, news, alumni, faculty and friends.
- Know at least three specific reasons why you want to work with this organization (can be its mission, values, service or other areas).

- Show your fit with the organization at this time
- Communicate why this position fits with your career path now.
- Explain how this position fits into your long-range career plans.

Step One: Anticipate

1. Thoroughly review the job description
 - Highlight the essential skills/experiences
2. Review Intranet Prepare to Interview resources,
 - Prepare to Interview Handout
 - Function specific guides with common questions
3. Review Intranet function/industry-specific resources:
 - Research Career Components/Research Industries and Roles> choose your interest and then see the Prepare for an Interview section
4. Consult with your peers and alumni in target area
5. Research the Company
6. Think like an interviewer.
 - Ask yourself—“What are the weaknesses in my candidacy?”
 - Review Employer Feedback Common Mistakes Handout

Type of question	Examples	Strategies for responding
Behavioral	• Tell me about a time when the necessary data to make a decision was inconclusive. • Give an example of a time you your opinion was challenged. How did you handle it? • Tell me about a time you were able to successfully overcome large-scale, complex issue by changing or implementing a technical solution.	• Situation • Obstacle • Action • Result
Technical	• What are the different ways to value a company? • Which is a better long-term investment, Priceline.com or eBay?	• Begin by outlining your strategy, methodology, decision framework, etc. Include the “whys” in your response. • Ask questions for clarification and additional information when needed. • Where appropriate restate/summarize your conclusions.
Self-Awareness/Self Assessment	• What was the riskiest decision you have made? • What do you consider to be your greatest achievements to date? Why? • What things give you the greatest satisfaction at work? • What things frustrate you the most? How do you usually cope with them? • If you were an item on a pizza, what would it be? • What type of musical instrument would you be?	• Begin your response by restating the question. Make sure you address the “why” factor. For example: My philosophy on management is... • Consider addressing the underlying “fit question” relative to the position/organization as you formulate your response.
Fit	• Why do you want to work here?	• Articulate the reasons why you are a good match for the position and the company throughout the interview. • Ask intelligent questions about the company.
Stress	• Interviewers may ask questions quickly, using a “rapid fire” approach. • Interviewers may act disinterested, bored, or begin answering emails during your conversation.	• Stay calm. Understand what they are assessing – they are trying to get a sense of how you deal with an unexpected and/or uncomfortable situation. • Practice thinking on your feet.
Case/Problem Solving	• If we were to open another hub, where should it be? • Imagine you’re the product manager for an AWS service that bills based on usage. You receive a report from one of your largest clients that they are being overcharged. • Why are manhole covers round? • How would you find a needle in a haystack?	• Practice using case interview resources to demonstrate how you analyze a situation and respond quickly and thoroughly. • Where possible incorporate frameworks, specifics and creativity.

Step Two: Plan Your Responses

1. Write out your response to each anticipated question
2. Identify key skills and the stories you want to tell that highlight your greatest successes
3. Practice your responses and get feedback
4. Edit your responses so that they are concise
5. Manage your nervous behaviors

Step Three: Rehearse

1. Deliver your responses in front of a mirror or by using a voice recorder or video on your smartphone
2. Deliver your responses to a friend or peer
3. Utilize the Elevator Pitch module of [Vmock](#)
4. Use student groups and Career Services coaches

Interview Quiz

Zoom Polling

Next Steps

- <https://intranet.chicagobooth.edu/secure/evewkd/careers/market-yourself/prepare-to-interview>
 - Interview Formats
- Review and answer questions from [Function/industry Guides](#)
- Read the Prepare to Interview section of your preferred area [in Research and Roles](#)
- Review Preparing for Interview Handout
- Read Interview Mistakes Handout
- Practice using Elevator Pitch in [VMOCK](#)
 - Login with your original booth email address (not alias, find this in GTS profile)
- Interview Discussion Program Wed. Feb 16th 5:15pm

More Resources

Case Interview Practice

- [RocketBlocks](#) case prep

Books

- *Winning Job Interviews* – Dr. Paul Powers
- *How to Interview Like a Top MBA* – Dr. Shel Leanne

CareerCast (<https://www.chicagobooth.edu/careercast>) :

- *The Career Story that Commands Attention* – John McCormack
- *The Power of a Compelling Career Story* – Jim Signorell
- *Your Career Story: Communicating to Influence* – Ben Decker

Thank you for attending

Please complete the survey

**Schedule a coaching session or
Mock Interview on GTS**

**Contact Career Services at:
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312-464-8677**